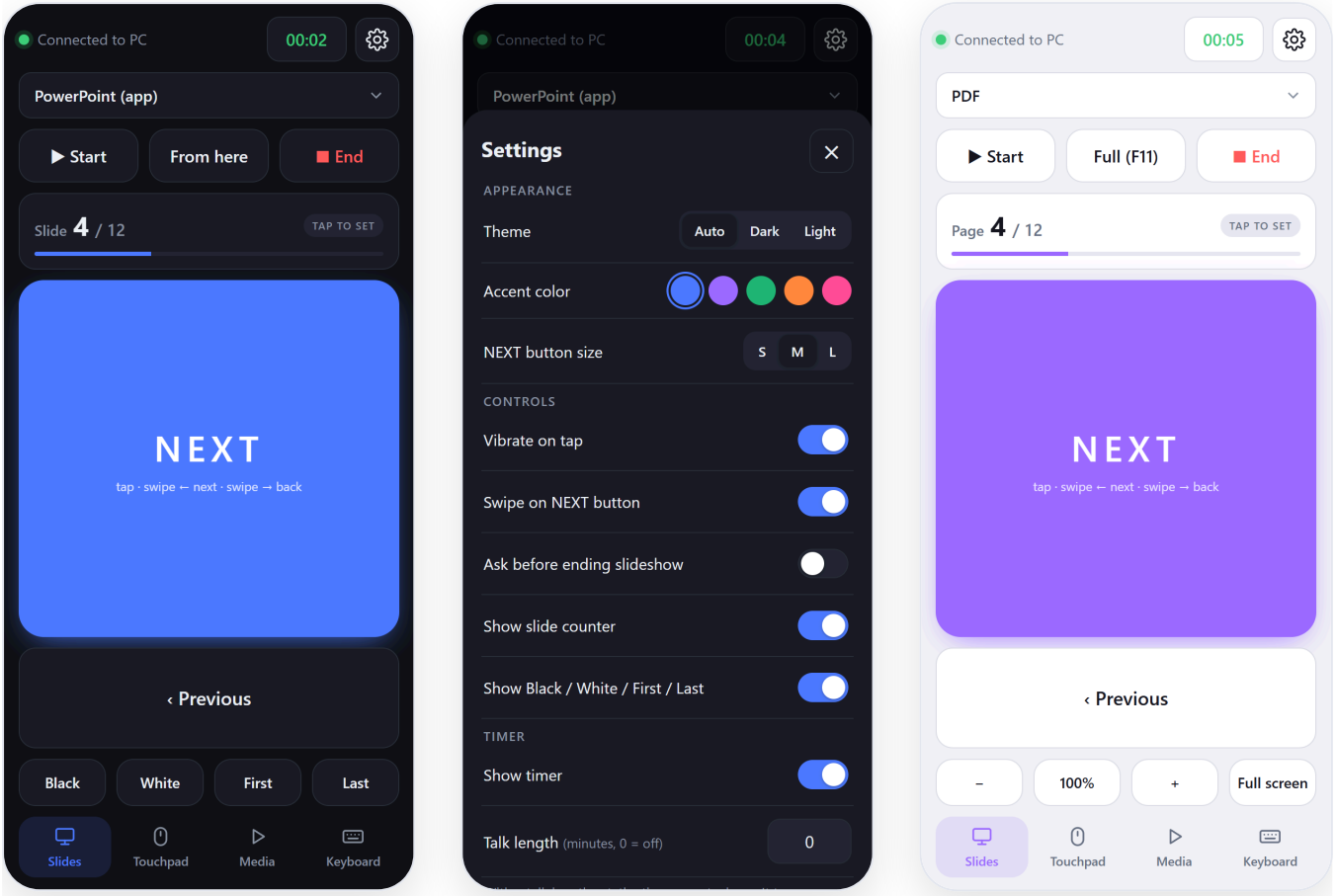
Phone Clicker

Turn your phone into a wireless presentation clicker for PowerPoint, Google Slides, Keynote, PDFs, videos and more.



What's inside

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By Yashwanth Nagaraju · MIT License

1. How it works

Phone Clicker has two parts:

📱 Your phone
A web page in any browser. Nothing to install.

→

📶 Same Wi-Fi
A private, direct link with a secret token

→

💻 Your laptop
A small program that presses keys and moves the mouse

When you tap **NEXT** on your phone, the laptop program presses the `→` key for you, exactly as if you'd pressed it on the laptop's keyboard. That's why it works with almost every app: PowerPoint, Google Slides, PDF readers, YouTube, Canva and more.

What you need

Item	Details
A laptop	Windows 10/11, macOS, or Linux (X11 session)
Python 3.9+	Free from python.org. It runs the laptop program
A phone	Any phone with a web browser (Chrome, Safari, Firefox, Samsung Internet)
Same network	The phone and laptop on the same Wi-Fi. A phone hotspot works too

The four tabs at a glance

🎯 Slides
Start, move through and end a slideshow, with the slide number and a timer. You'll use this tab most of the time.

🖱️ Touchpad
Your phone becomes a mouse, for clicking links, playing embedded videos or opening files mid-talk.

🎵 Media
Play/pause, volume, full screen, zoom and switch app, for videos, music or zooming into details.

⌨️ Keyboard
Type on your phone and the text appears on the laptop, for searching or typing a URL from across the room.

> **Private by design.** Every time Phone Clicker starts, it makes a new secret link. Only phones that scanned *that* QR code can control your laptop. Everything stays on your local network, and nothing is sent over the internet.

2. Installing

You only need to do this once per laptop.

Step 1: Install Python

Open a terminal (on Windows, *Command Prompt* or *PowerShell*) and type:

```
python --version
```

If you see `Python 3.9` or higher, skip to Step 2. Otherwise:

- **Windows:** download from **python.org/downloads**. On the first installer screen, **tick "Add python.exe to PATH"**, then click *Install Now*.
- **macOS:** download from python.org, or run `brew install python`.
- **Linux:** usually already installed. If not, run `sudo apt install python3 python3-venv`.

> **Windows users:** forgetting the "Add to PATH" box is the #1 setup problem. If `python` isn't recognized, re-run the installer, choose *Modify*, and enable *Add Python to environment variables*.

Step 2: Download Phone Clicker

- **With Git:** `git clone https://github.com/YOUR-USERNAME/phone-clicker.git`
- **Without Git:** on the GitHub page, click the green **Code** button, choose **Download ZIP**, and unzip it somewhere easy to find, such as your Desktop.

Step 3: That's it

The start script installs everything else automatically the first time you run it (about a minute). It installs:

Package	What it does
aiohttp	Runs the small web server your phone connects to
pynput	Presses keys and moves the mouse on the laptop
qrcode	Draws the QR code you scan
pywin32	Windows only: reads the live slide number from PowerPoint

Everything goes into a private `.venv` folder inside the project, so it won't affect other Python programs on your laptop.

3. Starting and connecting

Start the laptop program

Laptop	How to start
Windows	Double-click **start.bat** in the phone-clicker folder
macOS / Linux	Open a terminal in the folder and run `./start.sh` (the first time, you may need `chmod +x start.sh`)

Allow it the first time

- **Windows Firewall** pops up and asks about Python. **Tick "Private networks" and click Allow.** If you skip this, your phone can't connect.
- **macOS** blocks key presses until you allow it. Go to *System Settings → Privacy & Security → Accessibility* and turn on the app you started it from (Terminal, iTerm or VS Code).

Connect your phone

1. A page with a big **QR code** opens on the laptop. The same code is also printed in the terminal window.
2. Open your phone's **camera**, point it at the QR code, and tap the link that appears.
3. The remote opens. Check that the top-left says ● **Connected to PC** (or Mac) with a **green dot**.

> **Keep the laptop window open** while you present. Closing it, or pressing `Ctrl` + `C`, stops Phone Clicker. The link changes every time you restart it, so scan again after a restart.

If the dot is red

The phone shows **"Reconnecting..."** and dims the buttons whenever the connection drops, and it reconnects on its own as soon as it can. If it never turns green, see **section 13, Troubleshooting**.

Optional: command-line options

```
python server.py --port 9000      # use a different port
python server.py --no-browser     # don't open the QR page on the laptop
```

4. Giving a presentation

1. On the laptop, **open your presentation** (or PDF) and **click on it once** so it's the active window.
2. On the phone, choose your app from the dropdown at the top, for example **PowerPoint (app)**.
3. Tap ▶ **Start**. The slideshow starts full screen and the timer starts counting.
4. Tap the big **NEXT** button to go forward. Tap ‹ **Previous** to go back.
5. Glance at the **slide number** card to see where you are, and the **timer** to see how long you've been talking.
6. Tap ■ **End** when you're done. The timer pauses.

> **The golden rule:** Phone Clicker presses keys in **whichever window is active** on the laptop. If you tap NEXT and nothing happens, someone probably clicked another window. Click your presentation once and carry on.

Swipe gestures

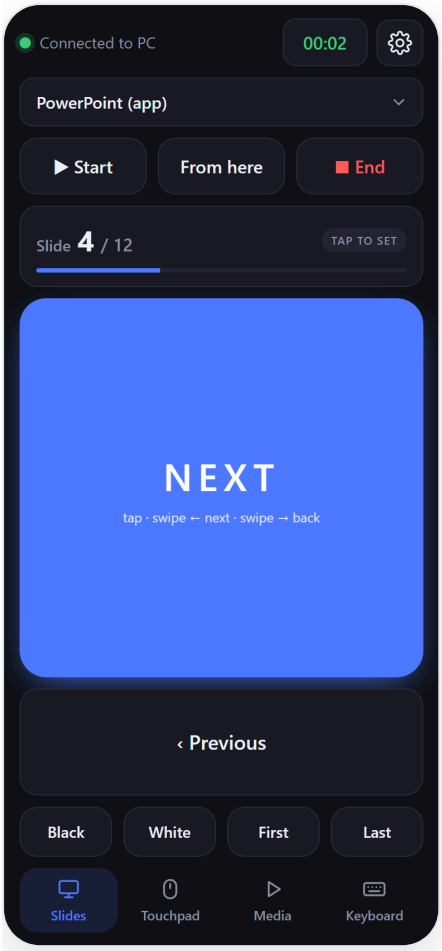
Gesture on the NEXT button	Result
Tap	Next slide (or next animation)
Swipe left ←	Next slide
Swipe right →	Previous slide

You can turn swiping off in Settings if you find yourself swiping by accident.

Presenting from a PDF

Choose **PDF** in the dropdown. NEXT and Previous then use `Page Down` / `Page Up`, which work in every PDF reader. **Start** enters Adobe Acrobat's full-screen mode (`Ctrl` + `L`). **Full (F11)** makes your browser (Chrome or Edge) full screen. The bottom row becomes **zoom −, 100%, zoom +** and **Full screen**.

5. The Slides tab



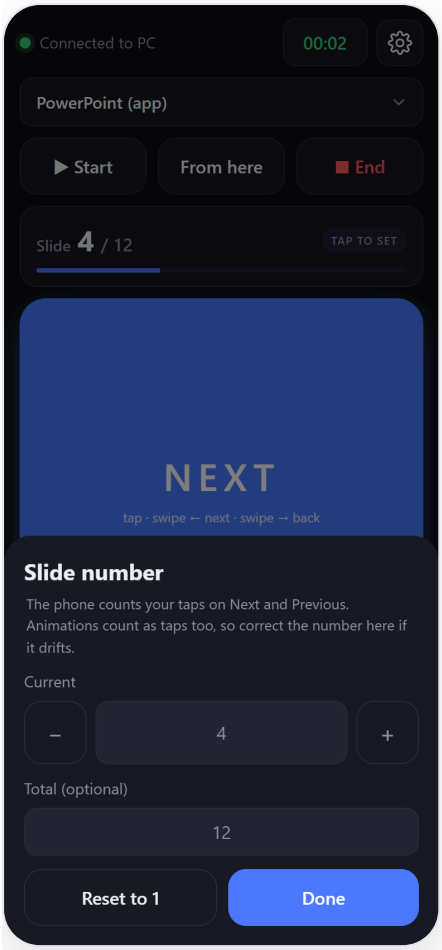
Slides tab in PowerPoint mode

This is the main screen. It has everything you need to run a talk.

Control	What it does
● **Connected**	Green means you're connected to the laptop. Red means it's reconnecting
00:00	The talk timer. Tap to start or pause, double-tap to reset. See Settings to set a countdown
⚙	Opens Settings
App dropdown	Tells Phone Clicker which app you're using, so Start sends the right shortcut
▶ Start	Starts the slideshow from the first slide, and starts the timer
From here	Starts the slideshow from the slide currently selected on the laptop
■ End	Exits the slideshow (`Esc`) and pauses the timer
Slide 4 / 12	Where you are in the deck. Tap it to correct it (see section 6)
NEXT	Next slide or animation. It's big so you can hit it without looking
‹ Previous	Back one slide or animation
Black	Blacks out the screen, which pulls the audience's attention to you. Tap again to come back
White	Turns the screen white, which is handy as a "whiteboard" pause
First / Last	Jump straight to the first or last slide, for example to your Q&A slide

> **Why is "From here" missing?** Some apps (PowerPoint for the web, and Keynote on Mac) have no keyboard shortcut for it, so the button hides itself.

6. The slide number



Tap the slide card to adjust it

The card above NEXT shows the current slide, the total, and a progress bar, so you always know how far through your talk you are.

Live mode: PowerPoint on Windows

When you use the **PowerPoint (app)** profile on a Windows laptop, Phone Clicker reads the slide number **directly from PowerPoint**. A badge shows where the number comes from:

Badge	Meaning
LIVE	The slideshow is running and the number comes from PowerPoint. It's always correct, even with animations, hidden slides, or if someone uses the laptop keyboard
EDITING	PowerPoint is open but not presenting. It shows the slide selected in the editor
TAP TO SET	Counter mode (below)

Counter mode: all other apps

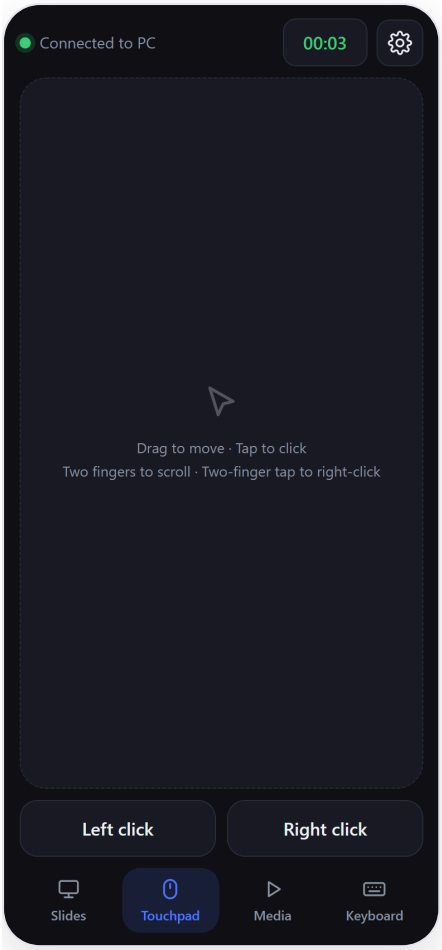
For Google Slides, PDFs, Keynote and others, the phone **counts your taps**: NEXT adds one, Previous subtracts one, and Start and First reset it to 1.

Tap the card to open the **Slide number** panel:

- **Current:** use − and +, or type a number, to fix it.
- **Total:** enter how many slides your deck has. This turns on the "/ 12" display and the progress bar, and stops the count going past the end.
- **Reset to 1:** start the count again.

> **Animations:** in counter mode, each animation step counts as a tap. If your slides have lots of animations, the count can run ahead. Just tap the card and correct it.

7. The Touchpad tab



Touchpad tab

This turns the big panel into a laptop-style trackpad, so you can control the mouse from anywhere in the room.

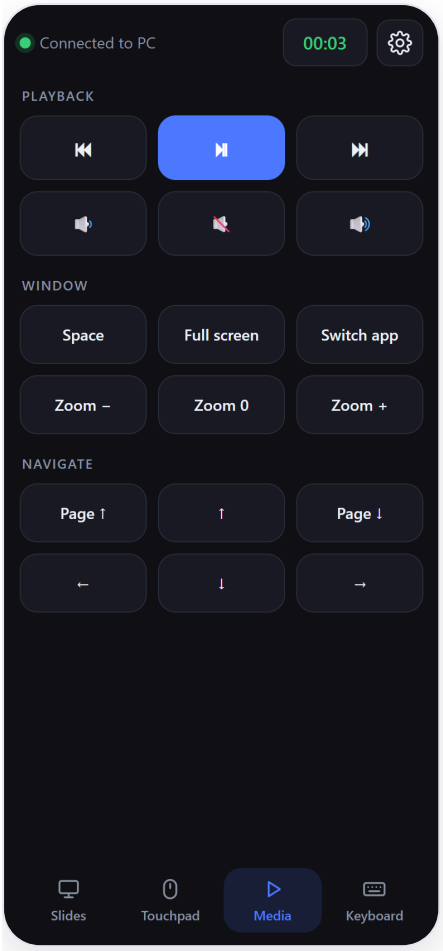
Gesture	Action
Drag one finger	Move the mouse pointer
Tap	Left click
Drag two fingers	Scroll up or down
Two-finger tap	Right click
Left / Right click	Buttons for precise clicks without tapping the pad

When is this useful?

- Clicking a **link** or **play button** on an embedded video inside a slide
- **Opening a file** or switching to another document during your talk
- **Scrolling a web page** or a long document while you explain it
- Pointing at something on screen: the mouse pointer works as a simple laser pointer

Change the **pointer speed**, **scroll speed** and **natural scrolling** direction in Settings.

8. The Media tab



Media tab

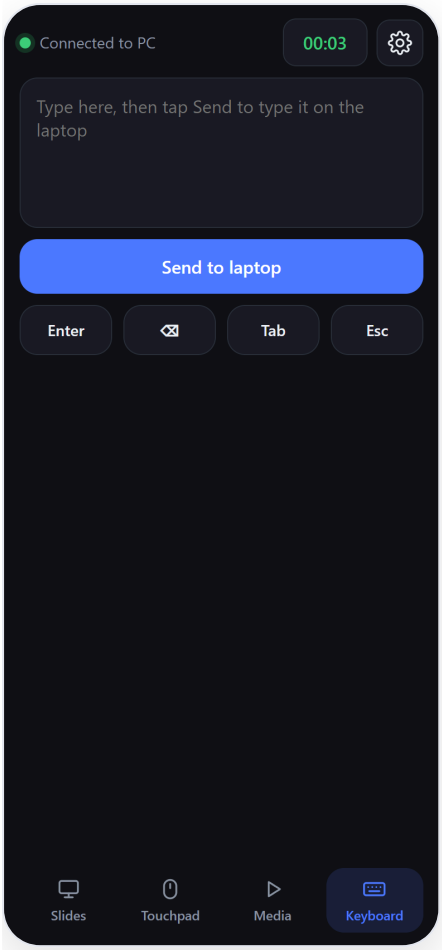
The media keys and handy shortcuts, grouped into three sections.

Button	What it does
Playback	
⏮ ⏯ ⏭	Previous track, play/pause, next track. Works with Spotify, YouTube, Windows Media Player and most browsers
🔉 🔇 🔊	Volume down, mute, volume up for the whole laptop
Window	
Space	Play/pause in YouTube, Netflix and most video players
Full screen	`F11`. Browser full screen
Switch app	`Alt` + `Tab` (`⌘` + `Tab` on Mac). Jump to the last app you used
Zoom − / 0 / +	Zoom out, reset, or zoom in (`Ctrl` + `−` / `0` / `=`)
Navigate	
Page ↑ / ↓	Scroll a page at a time
Arrows	The four arrow keys

When is this useful?

- Playing a **video** during your talk and controlling the volume from the stage
- **Zooming in** on a chart, spreadsheet or code so the back row can read it
- Jumping between your slides and a **live demo** with Switch app

9. The Keyboard tab



Keyboard tab

Type with your phone's keyboard and send the text to the laptop.

1. Tap the text box and type (voice dictation works too).
2. Tap **Send to laptop**. The text is typed wherever the laptop's cursor is.
3. Use **Enter**, ⌫ **Backspace**, **Tab** and **Esc** for the keys you'll need next.

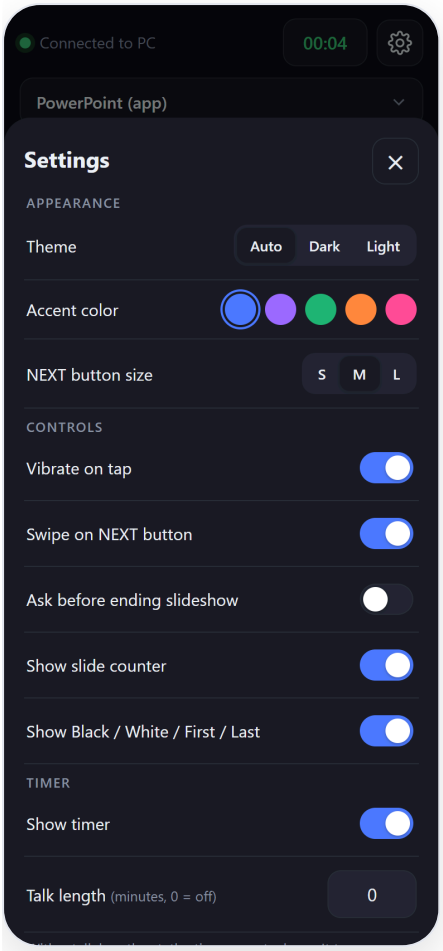
When is this useful?

- **Searching** for something the audience asks about, without walking back to the laptop
- Typing a **website address** into the browser
- Filling in a **sign-in or search box** during a demo
- Adding a quick note to a document while discussing it

> Tip: click into the right box on the laptop first (or use the Touchpad tab to click it), then send your text.

10. Settings

Tap the ⚙ **gear** in the top-right corner. Changes apply immediately and are saved on your phone, so they're still there next time.



Appearance and controls

Appearance

Theme	**Auto** follows your phone's dark/light mode. Or force **Dark** (best in dim rooms) or **Light**
Accent color	Blue, purple, green, orange or pink, for the NEXT button and highlights
NEXT button size	**S**, **M** or **L**. Smaller leaves more room. Larger is easier to hit without looking

Controls

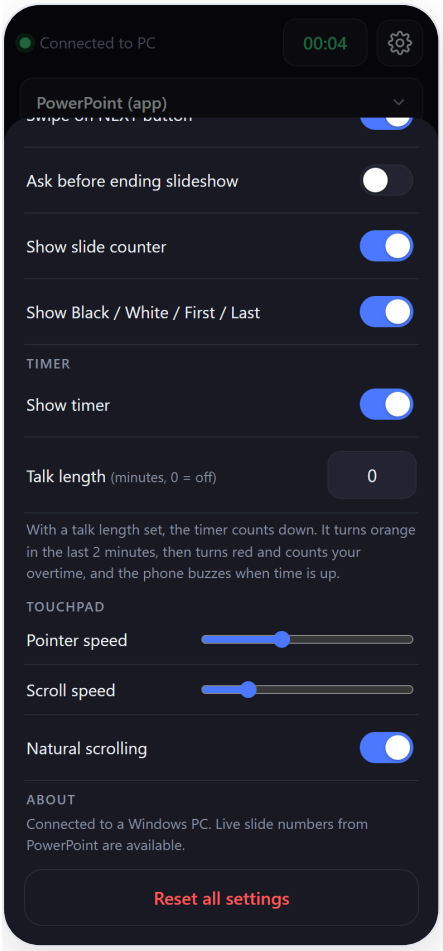
Vibrate on tap	A short buzz confirms each press (Android. iPhones don't allow web pages to vibrate)
Swipe on NEXT	Turn swipe gestures on or off. With it off, any touch on NEXT means next
Ask before ending	Shows "End the slideshow?" before ■ End, to stop accidental exits
Show slide counter	Hide the slide number card if you don't need it
Show Black / White…	Hide the bottom row for a cleaner screen

Timer

Show timer	Show or hide the timer in the top bar
Talk length	Set your time slot in minutes. The timer **counts down**, turns **orange** in the last 2 minutes, turns **red** and shows your overtime (e.g. **+01:20**) when you run over, and the phone buzzes when time is up. Set it to 0 to count up instead

Touchpad

Pointer speed	How far the mouse moves for each finger movement



Timer, touchpad and about

Scroll speed	How fast two-finger scrolling moves
Natural scrolling	On: content follows your fingers, like a phone. Off: the classic mouse-wheel direction

About

Shows what you're connected to and whether live slide numbers are available. **Reset all settings** restores the defaults.

11. App-by-app guide

Pick the matching option in the dropdown so **Start** and **From here** send the right shortcut. NEXT and Previous use the arrow keys, which work in all of these apps.

App (dropdown)	Start	From here	Notes
PowerPoint (app)	F5 Mac: ⌘⇧↩	Shift + F5 Mac: ⌘↩	Live slide numbers on Windows
PowerPoint (web)	Ctrl + F5	–	office.com in your browser
Google Slides	Ctrl + Shift + F5 Mac: ⌘⇧↩	Ctrl + F5 Mac: ⌘↩	Works in Chrome, Edge, Firefox
Keynote	⌥ + ⌘ + P	–	Shown only when connected to a Mac
PDF	Ctrl + L / ⌘ + L Acrobat full screen	F11 / ^ + ⌘ + F Browser / Preview	NEXT/Previous use Page Down/Up

Other apps

Anything that moves forward with the arrow keys works too. Pick **PowerPoint (app)** and use NEXT and Previous, then start full screen yourself on the laptop:

- **Canva** presentations, **Prezi**, **Pitch**, **reveal.js** and other HTML slide decks
- **Photo viewers** (Windows Photos, macOS Preview) for slideshows of pictures
- **Video players**: use the Media tab

12. Presenting tips

- **Test before your talk.** Connect, tap Start, and click through a couple of slides in the actual room.
- **Turn off your phone's auto-lock** (or set it to 10 minutes) while you present. Web pages can't keep the screen awake without HTTPS.
- **Use a phone hotspot** if the venue's Wi-Fi is a guest network. Connect the laptop to your phone's hotspot and everything works offline.
- **Set a talk length** in Settings so the timer warns you before you run over.
- **Use Black** to pull attention back to you during discussions, and tap it again to return to your slides.
- **Keep the laptop plugged in** so it doesn't go to sleep during a long Q&A.
- On PowerPoint for Windows, **use the live slide number** to check your pace. The progress bar shows how far through you are.

13. Troubleshooting and FAQ

The phone can't open the page, or the dot stays red

- Check that the phone and laptop are on the **same Wi-Fi**. Turn off mobile data on the phone to be sure.
- **Guest, hotel, school and office Wi-Fi** often block devices from talking to each other. Use your phone's hotspot instead.
- **Windows Firewall:** open *Windows Security → Firewall & network protection → Allow an app through firewall*, find **Python**, and tick **Private**. Also make sure your Wi-Fi is set to *Private* (not Public) in Windows network settings.
- Make sure the Phone Clicker window is still open on the laptop.

Green dot, but nothing happens on the laptop

- Click on your presentation so it's the active window.
- Check that the dropdown matches the app you're using.
- **macOS:** allow Accessibility access (section 3).
- **Linux:** log in with an **X11/Xorg** session. Wayland blocks simulated key presses.

Start doesn't start the slideshow

Some browsers and laptops (especially ones with an `Fn` key) grab certain shortcuts. Start the show by hand on the laptop. NEXT and Previous will still work.

The slide number is wrong

In counter mode, animations count as taps. Tap the slide card and correct it. On Windows with PowerPoint, pick the **PowerPoint (app)** profile to get live, always-correct numbers.

"python is not recognized"

Python isn't on your PATH. Re-run the Python installer, choose *Modify*, and enable *Add Python to environment variables*.

"Port already in use"

Another program is using port 8765. Run `python server.py --port 9000`.

Do other people need to install anything?

On their phone: no. It's just a web page. **On their laptop: yes.** Each presenter runs Phone Clicker on the laptop they're presenting from, because only a program running on that laptop can press its keys. Several phones can connect to the same laptop at once, which is handy for co-presenters.

Is it safe?

Yes. Each run creates a random secret token that's included in the QR code, and the laptop ignores any phone without it. The QR page itself only opens on the laptop. Nothing leaves your local network.